additional complications also arise. The Myanmar government and the Rakhine administration identify the Rohingya as a threat to their demographic map (Ahmed 2010; Morshed 2012). Alongside the infamous Burma Citizenship Law of 1982, several other discriminatory instruments — the Rakhine Action Plan 2014,[11] for example —also have been used to target the endangered community (Norwegian Burma Committee 2015). On 11 July 2012, the Myanmar president even suggested solving the Rohingya problem by expelling all Rohingyas or by having the United Nations resettle them — a proposal that a United Nations official quickly rejected (Al-Mahmood 2012).

In recent years Myanmar government higher-ups have claimed that the Bangladeshi authorities were pushing in (or allowing illegal migration into Myanmar of) its poor and unemployed from Teknaf, Cox's Bazar, and Chittagong. This is a serious allegation, but no field data were provided by Myanmar sources to substantiate it.[12] Nor was there an instance where Myanmar border authorities intercepted any large number of Bangladeshi migrants outbound to Yangon or any other Myanmar city (excepting the 'boat people', who are destined for longer journeys to third countries). Besides, the socio-economic conditions of Myanmar's bordering towns like Maungdaw or Buthidaung, or that of Rakhine State as a whole, do not bear possibilities for such popular migration from Bangladesh into Myanmar. Similarly, Myanmar's perceived threat from the increasing number of attempts by the Bangladeshis to migrate to Southeast Asia (usually Indonesia or Malaysia) using its land and sea areas also seems to be over-amplified since, after all, they do not seem to threaten its territorial integrity.

Threat perception in Bangladesh

Bangladesh remains one of the few countries in the world facing triangular problems of refugees, non-voluntary migration, and displacement — both environmental and man-made.[13] Its emergence as an independent country also bears testimony to the critical significance of refugee issues and concerns (Ahmed 2010, p. 3). Following this legacy, Bangladesh has over the years maintained a largely humanitarian approach in dealing with the Rohingya, and has exercised restraint in measures and counter-measures involving their exodus along Myanmar borders (Morshed 2012).